

D339 Task 1 Writing Guide

When writing a paper or essay at WGU feels daunting, this D339 Writing Guide will help you prepare your response to Task 1: The Explainer Blog Post with examples relevant to the task. This writing guide is helpful to use as a complement to the resources available through the Academic Coaching Center.

The following sections offer specialized guidance on writing the paragraphs for the Explainer Blog Post in D339:

1. An **introduction** paragraph.
2. One to two paragraphs **explaining the information technology** product, practice, or process (such as how it works, what its features are). You may often hear us refer to this as "main point #1."
3. One to two paragraphs **describing the benefits** of adopting the technology (or technological practice or process). Make sure to describe some benefits specific to the company. We often refer to this as "main point #2."
4. A **conclusion** paragraph.

^ The Introduction Paragraph

The introductory paragraph should include 3 parts:

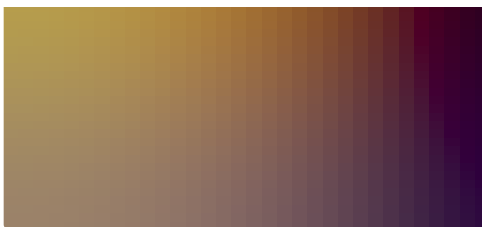
1. A **hook** to help capture the reader's attention.
2. The bridge, or **background information** for context.
3. A **thesis** statement that describes/previews the main points in the paper.

Sometimes the "background," "thesis," and "preview" of main points may all run together in one or two sentences. You are likely to find that to be true in Technical Communication. Below are some ideas and examples for each "part" of the introduction. All examples will be for a topic about a company (we named it the ABC Company) switching to Google Docs instead of using Microsoft Word.

Writing the Hook

Review the cards to reveal an example of each type of hook to begin your introduction. You only need one hook, not one of each kind. But these examples will give you some ideas of how to start your paper.





Writing the Background Information

Because the Blog Post for task 1 is not expected to be very long (2-3 pages maximum), most of your "background" will be in main point #1. For the introduction paragraph, you will likely just reveal the full topic of this blog post. Sometimes, your "hook" already does that. And you may decide you do not need any more background in the introduction. Below, we give you a few examples of "background" information you might see for a blog post introduction about switching from MS Word to Google Docs.

Stating the Topic



If it was not obvious in the hook, then the next part of your introduction may be to just make the topic clearer. For instance, if my "hook" was the analogy example where I compared cooking to using a word processing program, the actual topic of using Google Docs rather than Microsoft Word may not have been clear. So, I might add the following sentence after that "Analogy" hook to help clarify where this paper is going.

"Most assume Microsoft Word is the only program that meets those requirements, but that is not necessarily true."

Providing a Definition



For many technical topics, a definition of the topic or main term may be needed background that will go better in the introduction rather than the first main point. For instance, what if I thought that for my audience for this blog post, I needed to define "word processing"? So, my next sentence after my "hook" might be:

"Word Processing refers to the act of using a computer to create, edit, save, and print documents" (SUNY Broome CC, n.d.)

Add Statistics or Facts About Your Topic



Just like with the hook, an interesting statistic or fact about your topic may help make the introduction a little more robust. For our topic of switching to Google Docs, that same statistic used as an example for a "hook" could also work here as "background information." So, instead of using it as a hook, you would use it here. As a reminder, that example was:

"There are over 25 million Google Doc users worldwide (Earthweb, 2023)."

Writing your Thesis Statement

In another course at WGU, you may have encountered a template for a thesis statement. You certainly may be able to get that template to work for this course, but it may not always work as well here as it did in other courses. In other words, don't restrict yourself to any templates you may have seen in other communication courses.

The thesis statement should clearly state the main idea of the whole paper and then should preview the main points to come. This can be put into 1 or 2 sentences, but try to keep it within 2 sentences. The image on the right shows a good example of a thesis for our topic of switching to Google Docs.

ABC Company is switching to Google Docs for word processing to help save money. This blog will describe what Google Docs is and explain why this switch is beneficial to the company.

Example Introduction Paragraph

Below is an example of what your full introductory paragraph might look like for the task 1 Blog Post. We chose to use the "interesting facts" type of hook and a "stating the topic" type of background.

"Many people might think that Microsoft Word is the only real option for word processing, but there are dozens of other options. Microsoft Word is certainly the most widely used word-processing program, but it does cost money. Other word processing programs out there are free to the public. One such program is Google Docs. ABC company is switching to Google Docs for word processing to help save money. This blog will describe what Google Docs is and explain why this switch is beneficial to our company."

^ Paragraph to Describe the Technology

There are basic components to any one paragraph within the body of a paper.

1. A sentence describing the main idea of the paragraph.

This is similar to a thesis for the paragraph. An example using our Google Docs topic would be:

Google Docs is a free web-based word processing program from Google.

2. Sentence(s) giving background to that idea.

An example using our Google Docs topic would be:

It was first started in 2006 and allows users to create documents just like Microsoft Word (Hanna, 2022). It is a part of Google Workspace, which is comparable to Microsoft Office Suite. Users can edit, collaborate, and share their work all on the web.

3. Sentence(s) giving examples or evidence.

These sentences should also include an explanation of how that information supports the main idea if it is not obvious. An example using our Google Docs topic would be:

It is a popular alternative to Microsoft Word. Companies using Google Docs include the United States Department of Defense and Costco Wholesale Corporation (Apps Run the World, n.d.).

4. Summary of the main idea of the paragraph or link back to the idea

This is to remind the reader of the main point of this paragraph. An example using the Google Docs topic would be:

The fact that this is a free service and other companies have had success using it makes this a great option for ABC Company.

If you put the above sample sentences in italics together, it would make a great first paragraph for main point 1 of the blog post. The next paragraph may continue to describe the features of Google Docs and how those compare to Microsoft Word. Once you believe you have enough information for main point 1 (this is likely to be anywhere from 1-4 paragraphs), you should write some paragraphs about main point 2 (the benefits).

^ Paragraph for the Benefits of the Technology

The following are examples for each of the 4 parts of a paragraph for main point 2 (about the benefits) for the blog post.

1. A sentence describing the main idea of the paragraph.

The benefits of switching to Google Docs abound.

2. Sentence(s) giving background to that idea.

Besides cost savings, Google has created this application so that users can work seamlessly with colleagues and with other applications.

3. Sentence(s) giving examples or evidence.

For instance, as you work on a document and ask people to review it, all collaborators will be able to see a history of any changes people made (Hanna, 2022). The web-based feature with auto-saving technology also means there is less likelihood of losing a large amount of created content. One can also move from computer to computer (or other device) if needed to complete work on a document.

4. Summary of the main idea of the paragraph or link back to the idea.

There are many other benefits as well.

Once again, if you put all 6 of these example sentences together, they make a good first paragraph for the main point about the benefits of switching to Google Docs. Since this sample paragraph is the beginning of a series of paragraphs about the benefits, we started and ended with a basic sentence about there being many benefits. The "background" and "evidence" sentences in this paragraph were then about "working seamlessly" with colleagues and with different devices. The next paragraph concerning the benefits might be about the ease of learning it because it is similar to MS Word and compatible with MS Word.

Certainly, more detail could be given on the benefits in this paragraph to help flesh out your paper. Likely, your "benefits" section will have 1-4 paragraphs. If there are many benefits, try to group some benefits together by similarity, as done above. If there are just 2-4 main benefits, write a short paragraph about each benefit.

^ The Conclusion

We have reached the end of this mini writing course, and the end of your blog. The conclusion is where you show your reader the light at the end of the tunnel of the blog topic. The concluding paragraph should relate back to your thesis. It is usually formatted in a sort of reverse introduction. So, three components, much like the introduction, but in reverse order:

1. Restate the thesis, review the main points.
2. Add any last "insight" to the topic.
3. End with something memorable (sometimes this links back to the "hook" from the introduction).

Example

This blog describes what Google Docs is and explains why this switch is beneficial to our company. Saving money is just one reason why ABC Company is making this switch. In addition, Google Docs is a part of Google Workspace, which has a whole suite of products that our company may find useful. The potential for our future is bright, and clearly, Microsoft products are not our only option to guide us toward success.

So, our conclusion paraphrased the thesis, then gave a little new info about Google Workspace, and finally ended by not only tying back to the first sentence in the introduction (about Microsoft Word not being the only word processing option), it ends memorably by talking about the future.

^ Sources Used in the Writing Examples

Apps Run the World (n.d.). List of Google Workspace (formerly Google G-Suite) Customers. <https://www.appsruntheworld.com/customers-database/products/view/google-workspace-formerly-google-g-suite/name/asc/10/4>(opens in a new tab)

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Hanna, K. T. (September 2022). Google Docs. <https://www.techtarget.com/whatis/definition/Google-Docs>(opens in a new tab).

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